

Ke Li

Personal Website: <https://kelichloe.github.io>

Research Interests

My research lies at the intersection of AI/ML, optimization, and decision making under uncertainty. I pursue two complementary streams:

- **Decision-Aware Learning:** developing machine learning and data-driven optimization methods that align learning objectives with downstream decisions, with applications to targeting, personalization, and marketing decisions;
- **Human-AI Collaboration / AI for Science:** studying how AI can augment researchers' workflows, particularly in scientific reasoning and theory building.

Education

INSEAD	France
PhD Candidate in Decision Sciences	09/2023 - Ongoing
Advisor: Spyros Zoumpoulis	

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen	China
B.Eng (Honors), Computer Science and Engineering	09/2018 - 06/2022

Honors & Awards

Academia and Research

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| – OpenAI Researcher Access Program (\$1,000 API credits) | 2026 |
| – <i>Stars of Tomorrow</i> Award for Outstanding Intern, Microsoft Research Asia | 2022 |
| – ExploreCSR Computing Research Award, Google Research & UTRGV [link] | 2021 |
| – China National Encouragement Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China | 2019 |
| – Dean's List, CUHK-Shenzhen | 2019–2020 |
| – Undergraduate Admission Fellowship, CUHK-Shenzhen | 2018–2022 |

Teaching

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| – Teaching Excellence Award in PhD Tutorials, INSEAD | 2025 |
| – Undergraduate Student Teaching Fellow, CUHK-Shenzhen | 2020 |

Working Papers

- [1] **Decision-Aware Customer Segmentation.** *Coauthors:* Sandeep Chandukala (SMU), Ernst Osinga (SMU), and Spyros Zoumpoulis (INSEAD).

Presentations:

- **2026: Best Paper Award**, Singapore Rising Scholars Conference (SMU); INFORMS Annual Meeting (San Francisco); M&SOM Conference (Harvard); ISMS Conference (Lisbon); Theory + Practice in Marketing (Esade).

- [2] **AI Theory Building.** *Coauthors:* Philip Parker (INSEAD), Phanish Puranam (INSEAD), Eric Uhlmann (INSEAD), and Spyros Zoumpoulis (INSEAD).

Presentations:

- **2025:** INFORMS Annual Meeting (Atlanta); AI Plus Management Doctoral Consortium (UCL).

Publications

See my [google scholar](#) page.

- [1] Zhou, B., Li, K., Jiang, J., & Lu, Z. Learning from Visual Observation via Offline Pre-trained State-to-Go Transformer. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS, Top-tier AI/CS/ML conference)*, 2023.
- [2] Dong, J., Li, K., Li, S., & Wang, B. Combinatorial bandits under strategic manipulations. In *the Fifteenth ACM International Conference on Web Search and Data Mining (WSDM, Top-tier data mining conference)*, 2022.
- [3] Liu, Y., Li, K., Huang, Z., Li, B., Wang, G., & Cai, W. EduChain: a blockchain-based education data management system. In *Blockchain Technology and Application: Third CCF China Blockchain Conference*, 2021.

Industry Experiences

Beijing Academy of Artificial Intelligence

Beijing

Reinforcement Learning Researcher (Full-time)

12/2022 - 07/2023

- Designed and trained intelligent agents capable of learning directly from high-dimensional visual observations in complex game environments such as Minecraft.
- Developed novel architectures combining convolutional encoders with deep reinforcement learning algorithms (e.g., PPO, DQN)
- Our research paper ([website](#)) is accepted by NeurIPS 2023.

Microsoft Research Asia

Beijing

Research Intern, Award of Excellent Intern

01/2022 - 06/2022

- Contributed to Microsoft's AutoML toolkit [NNI](#) (14,400+ GitHub stars), including transformer model-compression modules now integrated into both internal and external AutoML pipelines.
- Investigated model compression techniques for Transformer/BERT models, such as pruning, quantization, and distillation; optimized Transformer models for deployment by reducing parameters and memory footprint.

Shanghai AI Laboratory (OpenDI Lab)

Shenzhen

Reinforcement Learning Intern

08/2021 - 12/2021

- Contributed 1,600+ lines of code to the open-source [DI-engine](#) reinforcement learning framework (3,600+ GitHub stars).

ByteDance Technology

Beijing

Machine Learning Intern, Data AI Lab

12/2020 - 05/2021

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, INSEAD

Winner of Teaching Excellence Award

- Foundations of AI for Managers, MBA Course 2025.05 - 2025.06
- Foundations of AI for Managers, MBA Course 2025.01 - 2025.02
- Probability and Statistics, PhD Course 2024.10 - 2024.12

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, CUHK-Shenzhen

- MAT1010 Calculus I 2019.09 - 2019.12

Academic Services

Session Chair

- INFORMS Annual Meeting (co-chair with Spyros Zoumpoulis) 2026
Session Title: Advances in Data-Driven Decisions
- INFORMS Annual Meeting (co-chair with Spyros Zoumpoulis) 2025
Session Title: Estimation and Optimization in Data-Driven Decisions

Conference Reviewer

- NeurIPS (Top-tier conference in CS/ML/AI) 2024

Beyond Academia

Part-time model in Paris ([\[portfolio\]](#)).
Piano Grade 10.

Media

Student interview by CUHK-Shenzhen ([EN](#) version/[CN](#) version)